

Participant H

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 00:55

How do you define open science?

01:06

So the first thing comes to my mind when I talk about open science... is an umbrella term for anything open that leads to knowledge. So in terms of science includes both social sciences, humanities, and what we call sciences. And that also includes, you know, open data, open tools, open softwares... anything that contributes to knowledge creation and knowledge synthesis, whatever is part of that research lifecycle. And, like, all of it is. So that includes publication as well.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 02:03

That was a very robust definition. I like that. Thank you. Alright, question four, what is your experience with open science practices? And how do you interact with them?

02:13

Um, I would say, my main experience with open science comes from publishing, when it's Open Access articles. I'm thinking if I also interact with open data or not... personally, I try to publish in open access journals. There have been a few that, you know, I missed that because, I wasn't the person who made the call, in terms of publication. But in terms of open data, I can't remember if my data was ever open. Another thing I started to acknowledge is open methodology, especially with knowledge synthesis. Previously, I was very involved with Knowledge Synthesis, but I'm not doing that as much anymore. But just here and there. So going forward, I acknowledge that we can have open methodology and I can, you know, make sure that my methodology, the section I was part of, it's open.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 03:48

Can you say a little bit more about open methodology? What does that mean?

03:53

So, when it comes to knowledge synthesis, this is also an umbrella term for a methodology that used systematic reviews or scoping reviews or that type of reviews that aims to kind of have a comprehensive or robust or systematic search to gather all the available information. And then those methodology differs a little bit in terms of how it's been conducted. But the part that librarian or information specialist is involved is creating the search strategy and implementing the search strategy and getting the results. So because the librarian creates that work, they have intellectual property over that search strategy. So in previously, I was just making the search strategy available at the publication stage, but now, I realized that there are other options to make the search strategy available, you can deposit in a repository, you can make it available differently, especially because there are specific guidelines that you have to follow in order to conduct the search. And one of them is to make it available if you can at the end, so that's something I consider now.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 05:27

Okay, that's really helpful. Thank you. I wasn't familiar with that process. And here's question five. Where do you learn about open science practices?

05:40

I monitor a couple of listservs [...] I'm just looking for the name of the listserv... is lib license. I monitor that one. And I also monitor anything that comes from open access scholarly publishing association. I monitor those as well as, they have a lot of good workshops, webinars, conference, I try to not miss those. I also monitor CRKN, and OCAL listservs. And sometimes they talk about, you know, open access issues. Or if anything that, you know, it's new movement in terms of open access, and then Twitter.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 07:08

So I'm going to share my screen now I put question six in the chat. I'll read it in just a second. So question six, are there any barriers that prevent you from adopting open science practices in your work? So we can answer that question together. And then we can look at this list of barriers that were identified in a study conducted in Australia, with faculty and researchers. And you can see if any of them resonate with you, and then if there are barriers, we can talk about how you might overcome those barriers? So the first part of the question is just Are there any barriers that prevent you from adopting open science practices in your work?

07:49

Yes, there are some barriers, I have to say. And you want me to pick from the list, right?

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 07:56

You can. Some people use it as sort of inspiration. Some people choose not to look at it at all. It's really up to you. It's meant to be helpful.

08:05

I would say number two, in terms of, for example, in terms of negotiating with publishers, and even if they're not open access, if they're not, you know, if they're a hybrid, or they don't recognize the importance of open science, still we need to engage with those publishers, because they're consider important publishers and it's not like, I can say, "Okay, we cut you out. Don't we don't want to do business with you." It just, you know, is not the priority, I would say for the institution. A lack of supporting an infrastructure number nine, a little bit. We have contract with a lot of publisher that we you know, we can get discounts for APCs. But that I'm sure you will hear about that again. But it's a bit frustrating to be able to make sure all our authors are getting those discounts. It's just there is no good way of tracking that. And sometimes publishers or vendors are not helpful. So I would say that these are the main barriers. Yeah, and if, like just I'm looking at your section A and B. How we can overcome these barriers? So if, for example, part of promotion and tenure be how researchers are supportive of open science, that actually makes it easier for us to implement practices that enforce open science. So it's not about procedures, or impact factor. But you know, the value is on open science. So that makes it easier for us to practice that. And another one I was thinking is just because open science is such a complex issue, it's just hard. It's very difficult. When it comes to open access publishing, that's by itself is very complex, let alone the whole open science concept. So when it comes to open access.. I do recognize very important role in trying to diversify our initiatives and our actions in support of open access in order to have a more like healthier open publishing market, but sometimes difficult, because we are so tied with big publisher, major publishers, that sometimes just you know, you can consider a smaller organizations or associations. So it's just the publishing industry. That makes it one of the main barrier that we face in library.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 12:10

Okay, fantastic. Thanks for that answer. And then question seven is quite similar. So I just put it in the chat. Are there barriers that prevent other researchers, including students, other faculty, librarians or

administrators with whom you work from adopting open science in their research? Again, the same series of questions apply.

12:35

I would say for researchers, again, number two is the main one. Especially if they have to pay for it. Going through the publication experience, it's already very time consuming and difficult. So just considering whether the draw is open access or not, it might not really be a priority for most researchers. And a lot of time, I cannot really push them. Because you know, they have enough. They have enough on their plates. So yeah, I would say it's very similar. I think researchers, especially in medical sciences, have started to recognize the importance of open science, especially going through pandemic, and how COVID actually open everyone's eyes that if you have access to the information, especially the data, makes it more reliable, and transparent. And some articles got rejected, because the data was not available. It was then open to the community. So the whole results got rejected because of that. So I think we are doing better in terms of understanding what open science is all about.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 14:12

Fantastic. Thank you. So I can quit sharing my screen, we're done with that part. And then here's question eight, which is do you offer research support relating to open science practices? If so, what type of support do you offer and at what stage of the research cycle?

14:33

I'm kind of axillary help, if that makes sense. When it comes to licensing and... or if it's a new offer by a vendor or society that they want to move to open science or open access publishing. I sort of help feed the acquisition of that, or assessment of that part.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 15:04

Okay? And where does that typically fall in the research cycle?

15:10

At the very beginning, okay? So it's basically... or you can say the end as well, if the researcher wants to publish with a journal. And if you have membership, they can publish for free. So I'm part of the assessment of whether we should get membership or not. Also, we might get membership or self support this society or vendor, become partner with them. And then the articles are free to everyone to access. So it's kind of the beginning of the research cycle.

Madelin Burt-D'Agnillo 15:53

Got it. Okay, fantastic. And here's Question Nine, in your opinion, how important are open science initiatives at the University of Toronto?

16:06

They're very important, especially for the institution as large as we are, because I believe we set the tone, in Canada. A lot of people look to see what we do, vendors, as well as other universities and institutions. So any steps we take has kind of a snowball effect, I will say. So, for that reason, I think it's very important for us to be more strategic with our open science initiatives. Yeah, I look to see how other organizations have done it. So there are still a lot of great things we are doing, I would say, but, yeah.